Groups on Russia Progress Report

Rafael Campos-Gottardo & Alan Nemirovski

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Comments from meeting: Feb. 12, 2026

- Pro-Russia/Pro-Ukraine dichotomy in the long-run as opposed to doing the more granular "Russia appeaser" (only using dichotomous question around trade/security, i.e., Q73) –> appeaser group is conceptually too small over time
- "Other" group is too big
- Appeasers: also more broad appeasers (potentially on a more general note) –> sticking with smaller appeasers group for short
- Additional data sources: European Social Survey, European Values Survey (same as World Values Survey), Eurobarometer survey (look at those for addidtional Russia-related Q's?)
- Calling people that selected "Neither" or "Don't Know" as "Un-knowledgeable" (more broadly)

Long-term (simplified) measure

Long-term measure centered on dichotomous question for trade with Russia (Pro-Russia) or defence against Russia (Pro-Ukraine); all outstanding respondents tentatively classed as "Other".

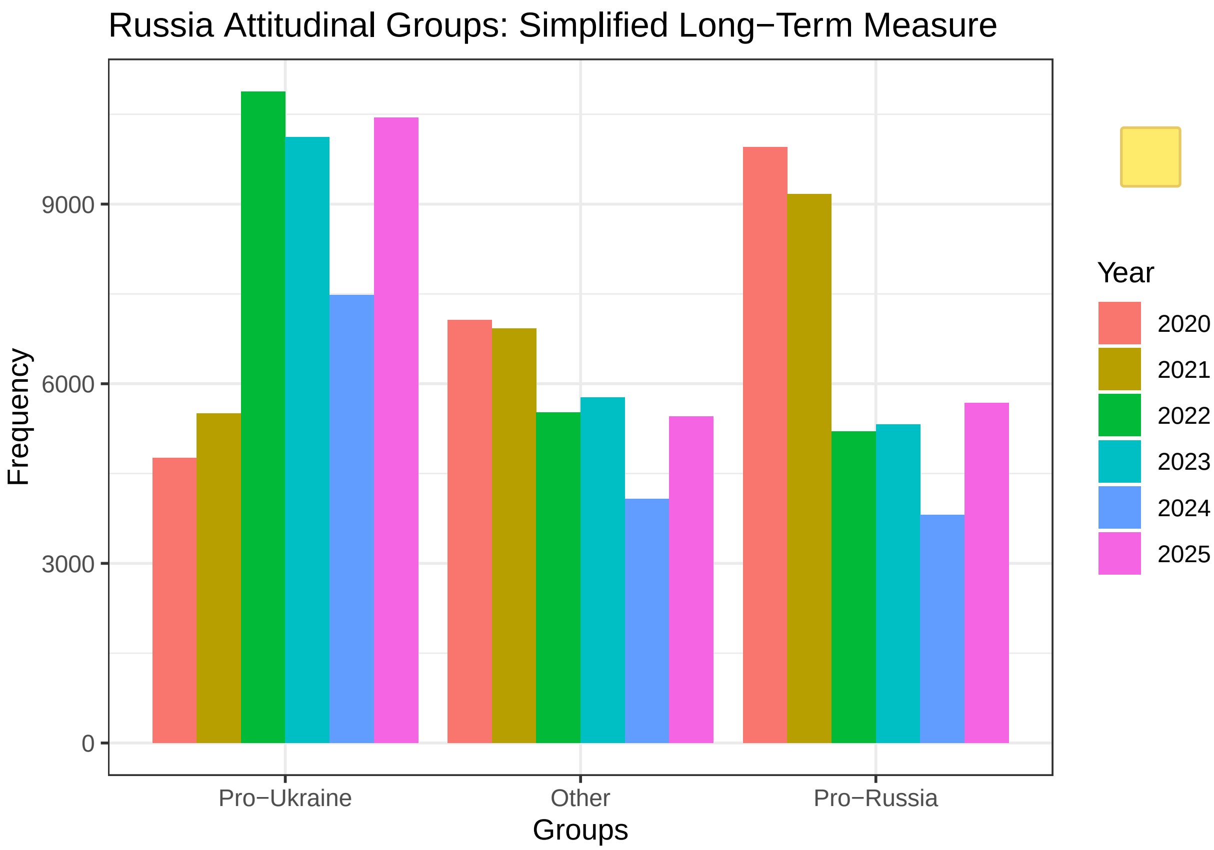
```
EUI_data <- EUI_data %>%
  mutate(ukrainegroups_long = case_when(
    #classed as Pro-Russia
    Q73 == "European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relatio
    #classed as Pro-Ukraine
    Q73 == "European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian agg
                                       TRUE ~ "Other"))

table(EUI_data$ukrainegroups_long)
```

```
##
##       Other  Pro-Russia Pro-Ukraine
##       53948       51603       57573
```

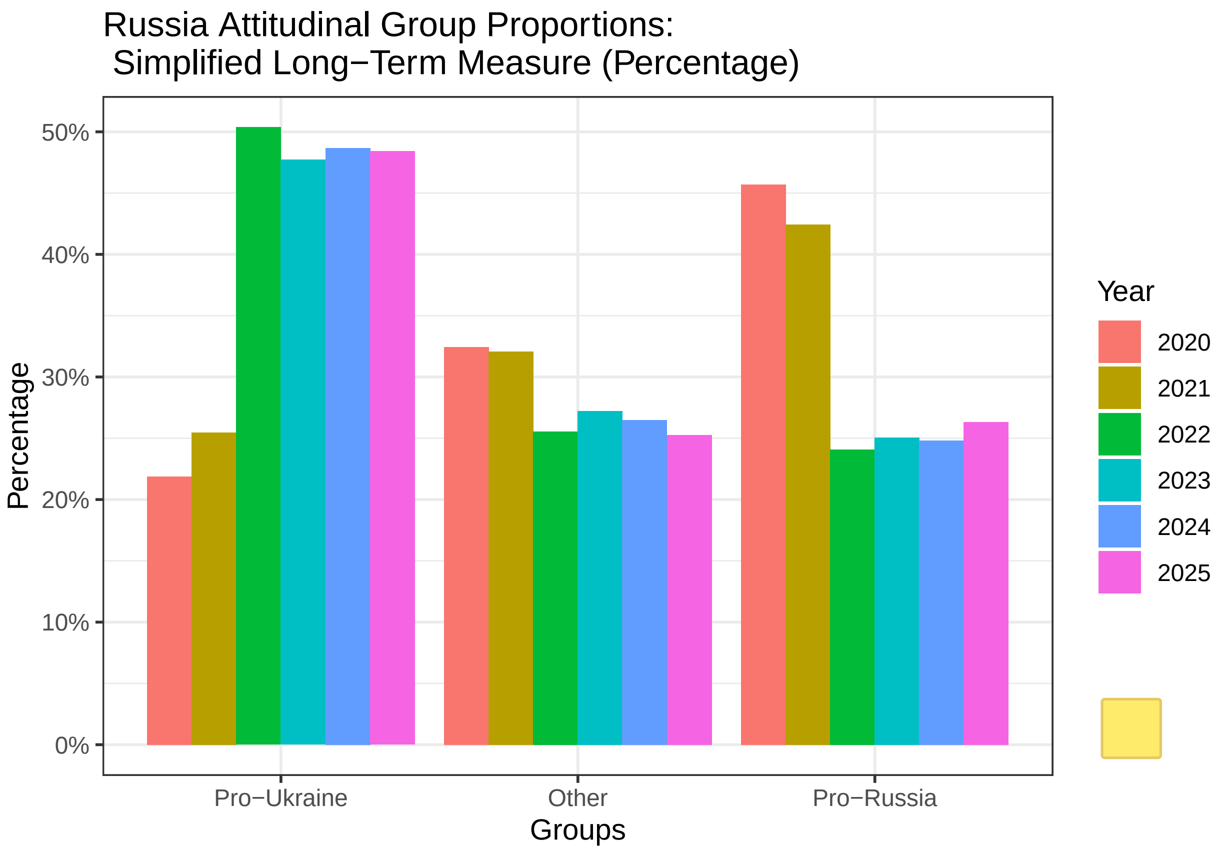
Trends over time: Long-term measure

```
COUNTRIES_2020 <- c("Denmark", "Finland", "France", "Germany", "Greece", "Hungary", "Italy", "Lithuania

#Frequencies
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2020) %>%
      mutate(ukrainegroups_long = factor(ukrainegroups_long,
                                       levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Other", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_long, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
```

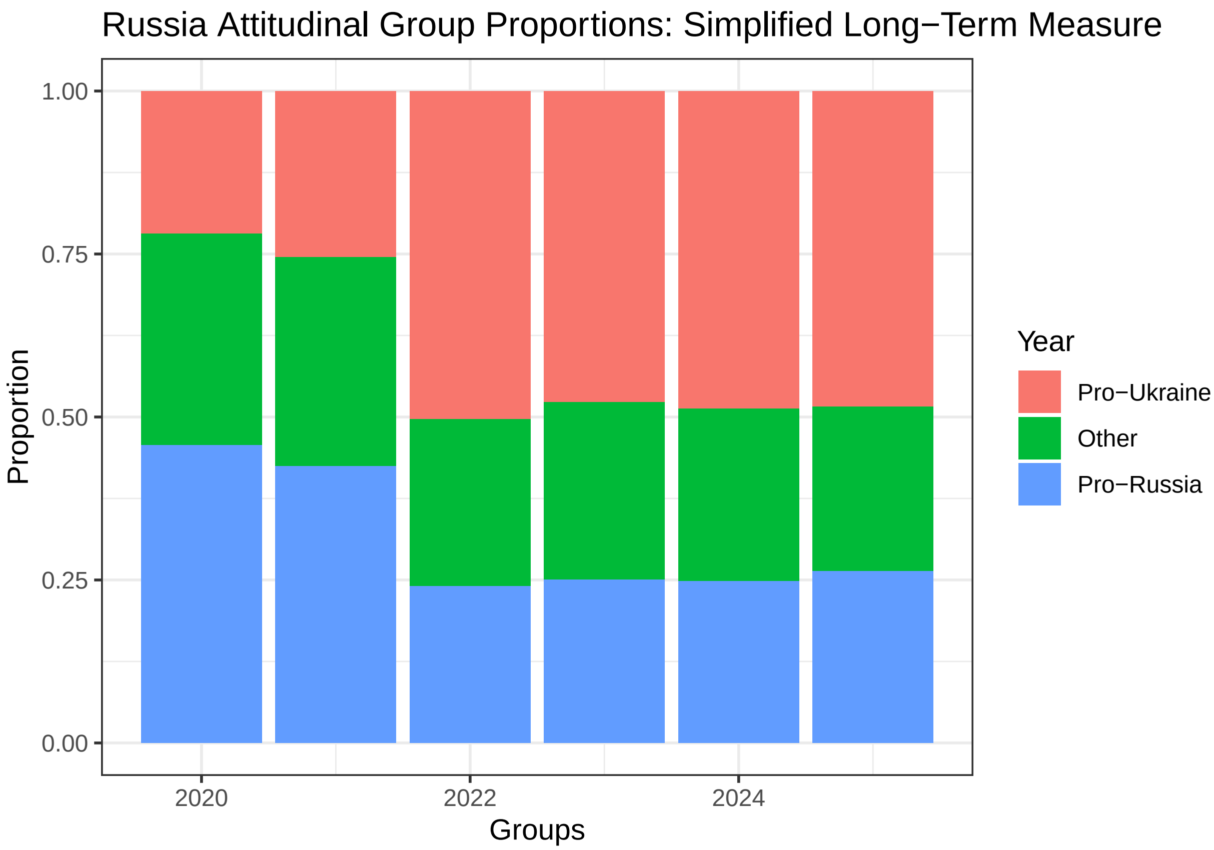
```
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Long-Term Measure",
       x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +
  theme_bw()
```




```
# Frequencies Percentages

  EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2020) %>%
  group_by(Year) %>%
  count(ukrainegroups_long) %>%
   # group_by(ukrainegroups_long) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) ) %>%
        mutate(ukrainegroups_long = factor(ukrainegroups_long,
                                     levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Other", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
    ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_long, y = Percentage, fill = as.factor(Year))) +
    geom_col(position = "dodge") +
      labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: \n Simplified Long-Term Measure
       x = "Groups", y = "Percentage") +
    scale_y_continuous(labels = scales::percent) +
      theme_bw()
```




```r
#Proportions
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2020) %>%
    mutate(ukrainegroups_long = factor(ukrainegroups_long,
                                      levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Other", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = Year, fill = as.factor(ukrainegroups_long))) +
  geom_bar(position = "fill") +
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Long-Term Measure",
       x = "Groups", y = "Proportion") +
  theme_bw()
```



Short-term (simplified) measure

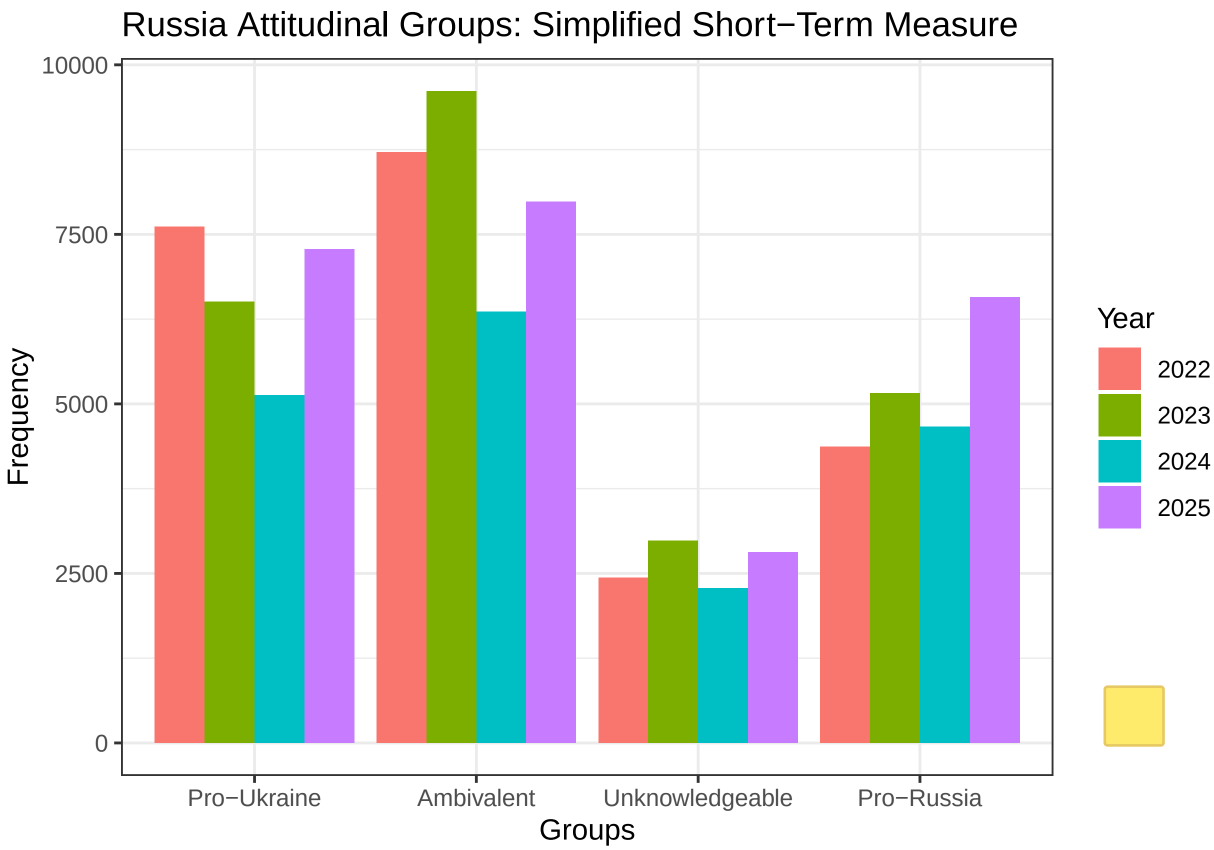
```
#creating "short" dataset for separate short-term variable manipulation
EUI_data_short <- EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2022)

EUI_data_short <- EUI_data_short %>%
  bind_rows(EUI_april_2022 %>% mutate(Year = 2022))


EUI_data_short <- EUI_data_short %>%
  #creating counts for "proukr", "prorus", and "dk" ("don't know") camps
  mutate(Q73_proukr = as.integer(Q73 == "European countries should invest more in defence and security t
         Q73_prorus = as.integer(Q73 == "European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy wi
         Q73_dk = as.integer(Q73 == "Neither/DK"),

         Q78_4_prorus = as.integer(New_Q78_4 %in% c(1, 2)),
         Q78_4_proukr = as.integer(New_Q78_4 %in% c(3, 4)),
         Q78_4_dk = as.integer(New_Q78_4 == 5),

         Q78_5_prorus = as.integer(New_Q78_5 %in% c(1, 2)),
         Q78_5_proukr = as.integer(New_Q78_5 %in% c(3, 4)),
         Q78_5_dk = as.integer(New_Q78_5 == 5),

         #summing responses in each direction per individual
```

```
         prorus_count = Q73_prorus + Q78_4_prorus + Q78_5_prorus,
         proukr_count = Q73_proukr + Q78_4_proukr + Q78_5_proukr,
         dk_count = Q73_dk + Q78_4_dk + Q78_5_dk,

         ukrainegroups_short = case_when(
           #at least 2/3 pro-Russia answers
           prorus_count >= 2 & proukr_count == 0
           ~ "Pro-Russia",
           #at least 2/3 pro-Ukraine answers
           proukr_count >=2 & prorus_count == 0
           ~ "Pro-Ukraine",
           #exactly 1/3 pro-Russia AND 1/3 pro-Ukraine answer
            (prorus_count == 1 & proukr_count == 1) |
            (prorus_count >= 2 & proukr_count == 1) |
             (proukr_count >=2 & prorus_count == 1)
           ~ "Ambivalent",
           #at least 2/3 "Don't Know's"
           dk_count >= 2 ~ "Unknowledgeable",
           TRUE ~ "Other")) %>%  #"Other" included as a fail-safe category
  filter(ukrainegroups_short != "Other") # The one other is a row that is all NA so it is filtered out

#Every individual was classed into one of four categories
#(we can see this because there is no "Other" category in the table)

table(EUI_data_short$ukrainegroups_short)
```

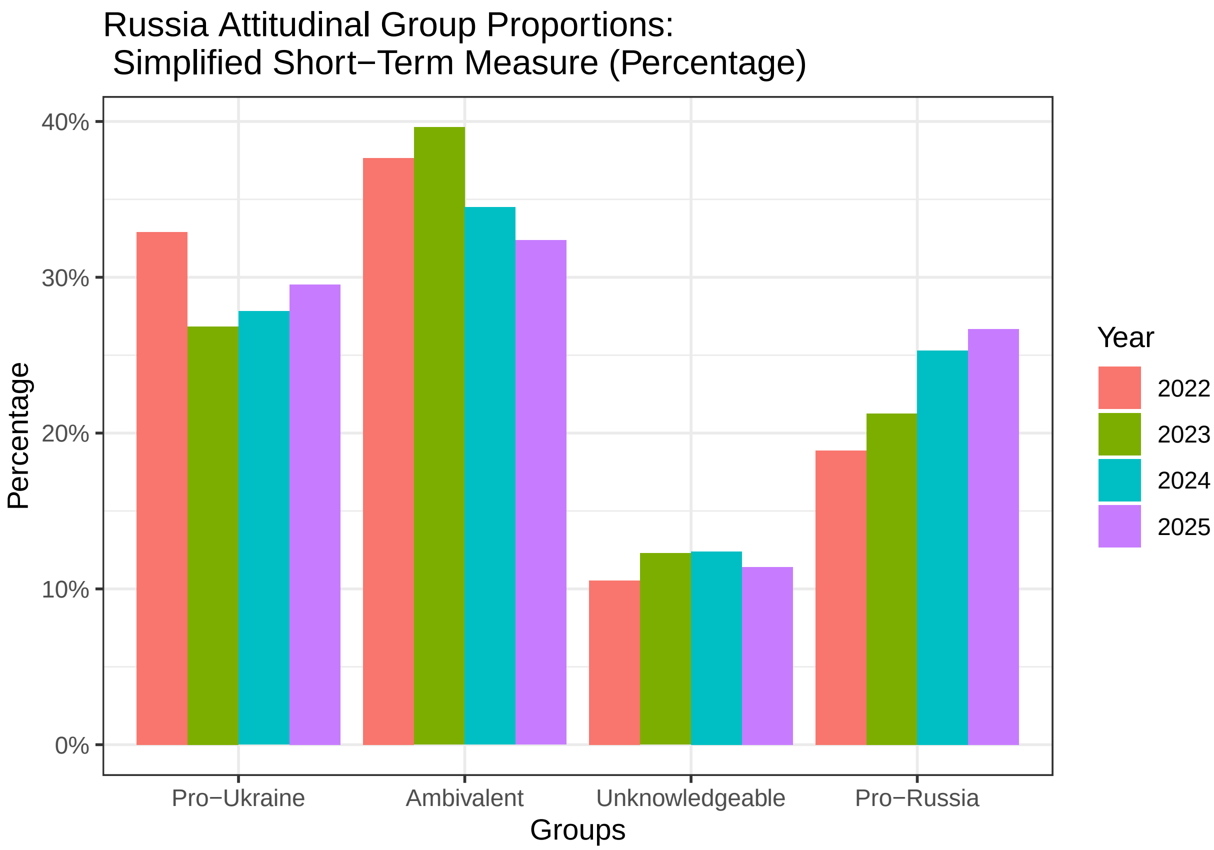
```
##
##      Ambivalent      Pro-Russia     Pro-Ukraine Unknowledgeable
##           35160           22383           27940           11136
```

Trends over time: Short-term measure

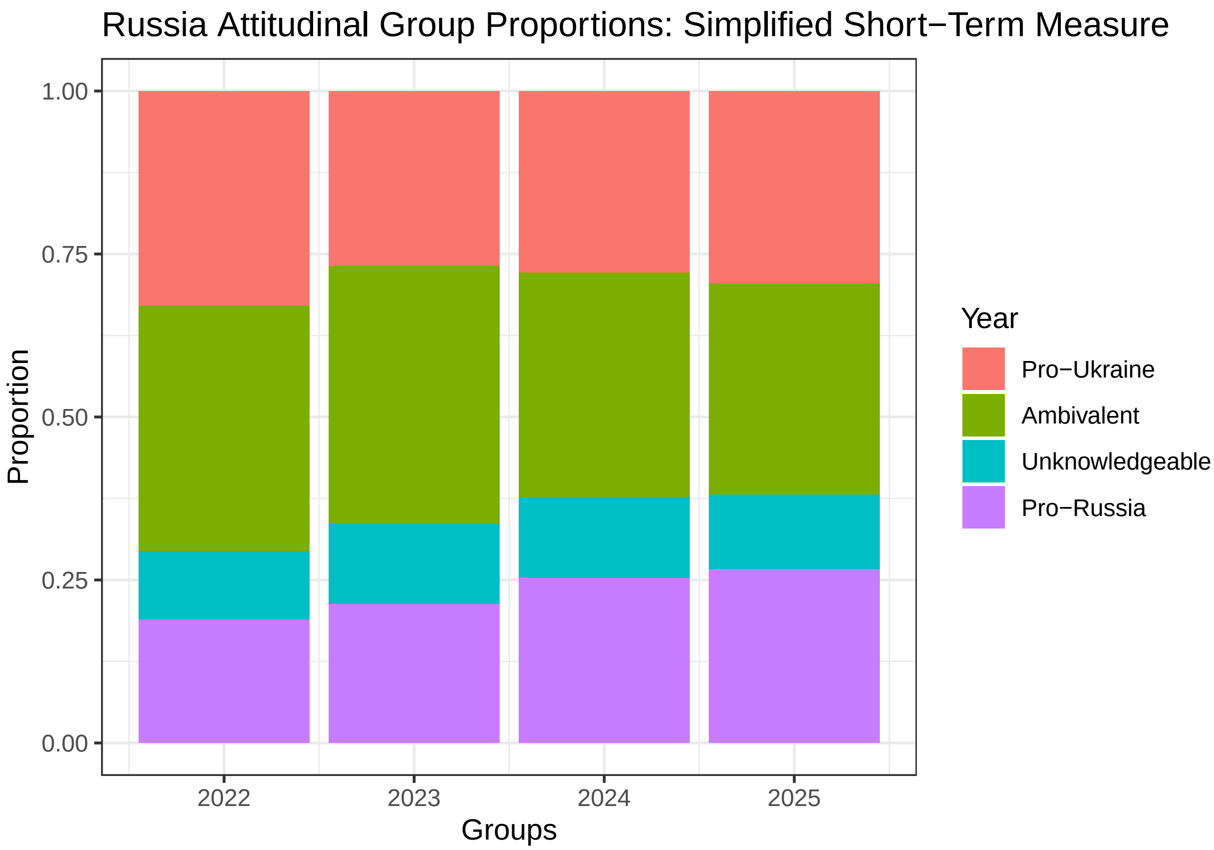
```
COUNTRIES_2023 <- c("UK", "Denmark", "Greece", "Hungary", "Lithuania", "Italy", "Poland", "Netherlands"

#Frequencies
EUI_data_short %>%
  filter(Year > 2021) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2023) %>%
    mutate(ukrainegroups_short = factor(ukrainegroups_short,
                                        levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Ambivalent",
                                                   "Unknowledgeable", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_short, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Groups: Simplified Short-Term Measure",
       x = "Groups", y = "Frequency") +
  theme_bw()
```




```
EUI_data_short %>%
  filter(Year > 2021) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2023) %>%
  group_by(Year) %>%
  count(ukrainegroups_short) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) ) %>%
    mutate(ukrainegroups_short = factor(ukrainegroups_short,
                                        levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Ambivalent",
                                                   "Unknowledgeable", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
    ggplot(aes(x = ukrainegroups_short, y = Percentage, fill = as.factor(Year))) +
    geom_col(position = "dodge") +
      labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: \n Simplified Short-Term Measu
       x = "Groups", y = "Percentage") +
    scale_y_continuous(labels = scales::percent) +
      theme_bw()
```



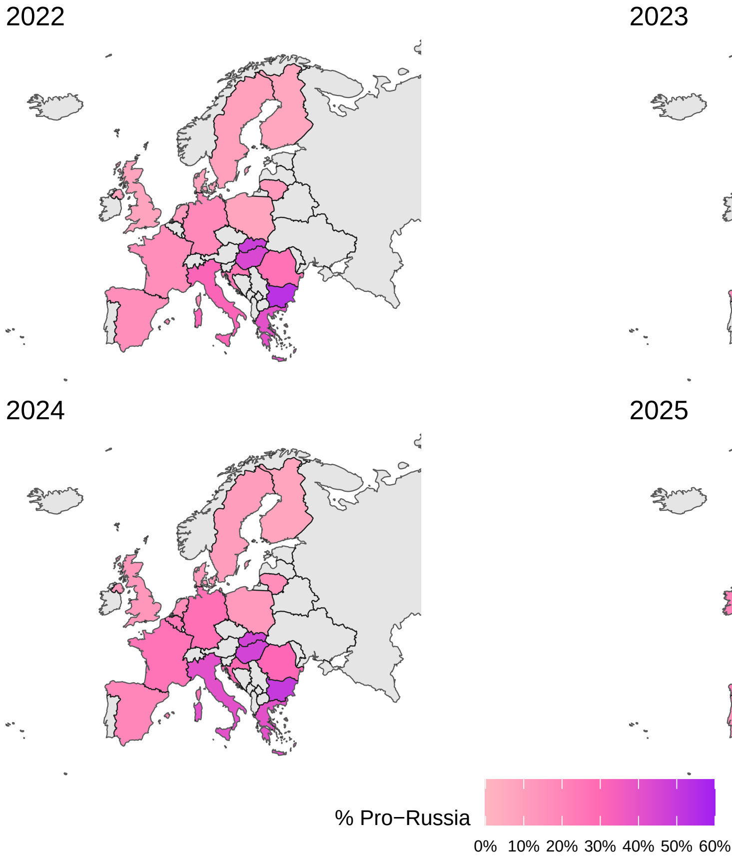

```r
#Proportions
EUI_data_short %>%
  filter(Year > 2021) %>%
  filter(country %in% COUNTRIES_2023) %>%
  mutate(ukrainegroups_short = factor(ukrainegroups_short,
                                      levels = c("Pro-Ukraine", "Ambivalent",
                                                 "Unknowledgeable", "Pro-Russia"))) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = Year, fill = (ukrainegroups_short))) +
  geom_bar(position = "fill") + #for frequency, change position to "dodge"
  labs(fill = "Year", title = "Russia Attitudinal Group Proportions: Simplified Short-Term Measure",
       x = "Groups", y = "Proportion") +
  theme_bw()
```



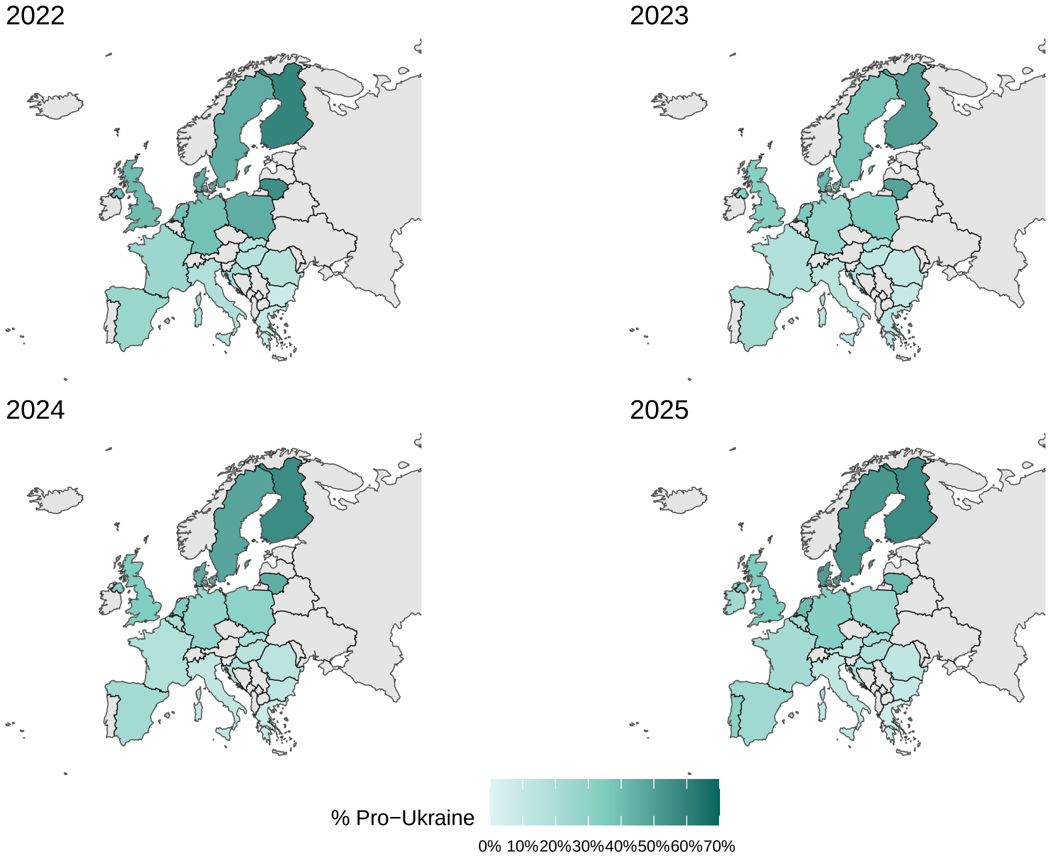
So when they answer all three: defense/trade military aid ukraine santions ukraine in one direction, they go towards pro-Russia or pro-Urkaine. If only two items do that –they also go in that direction. But not when the third item goes in the opposite direction, then they become ambivalent. Rafael, I do not see that particular code, can you double check. Also, when they have more than one DK they become Unknowledgable.

Country-level trends along new short-term measure

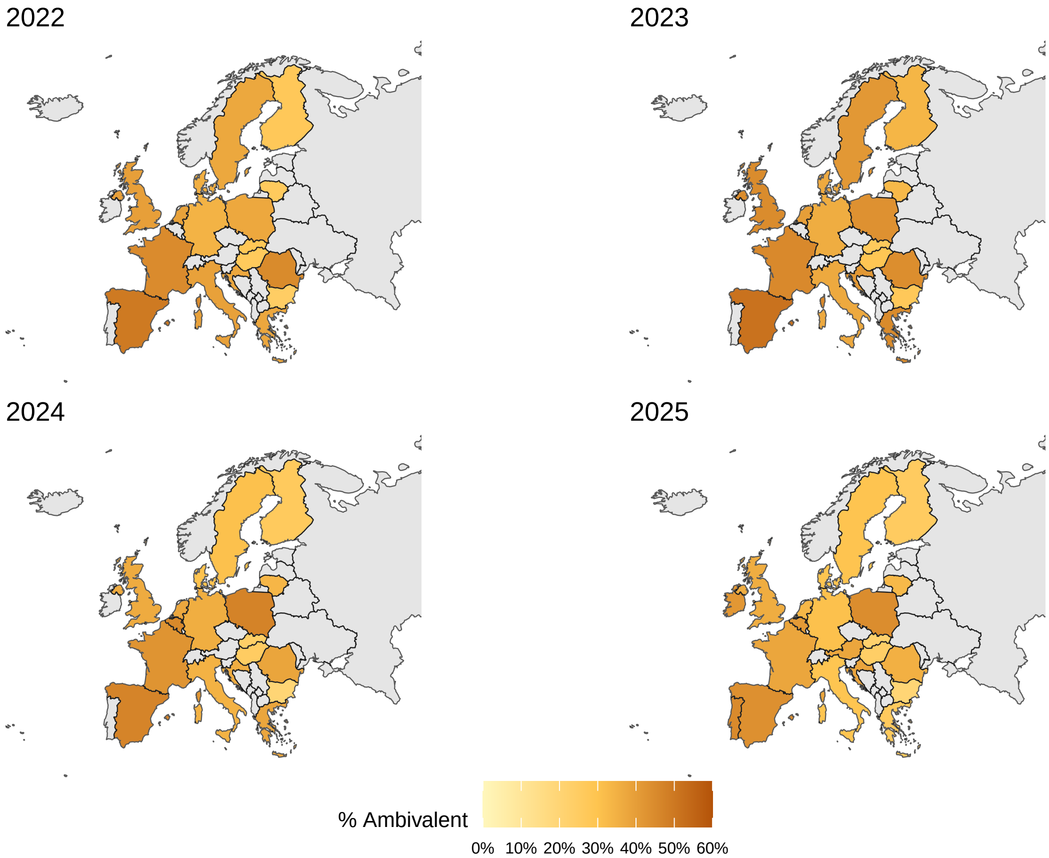
Pro-Russia



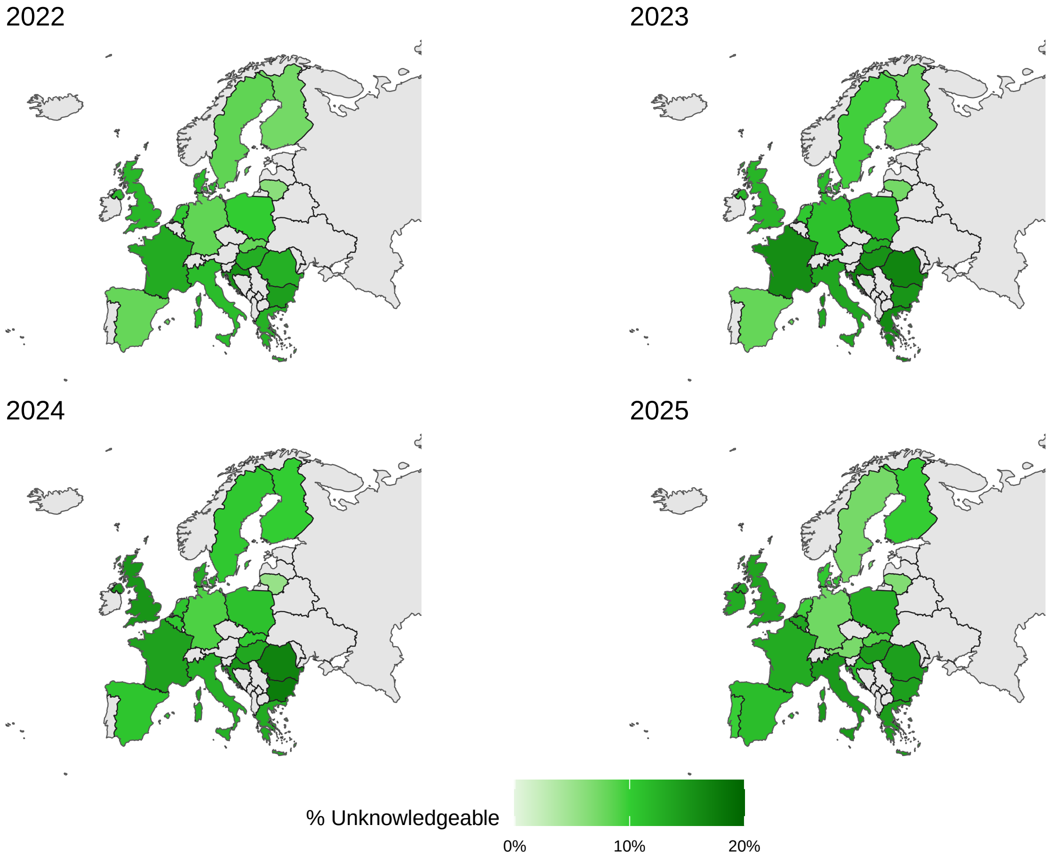
Pro-Ukraine



Ambivalent



Unknowledgeable



Examining the Ambivalent

Q73	Send_weapons	Higher_Energy	n	Percent
European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression	Do Not Support	Do Not Support	5601	15.93
European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression	Do Not Support	Don't Know	410	1.17
European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression	Do Not Support	Support	1666	4.74
European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression	Don't Know	Do Not Support	767	2.18
European countries should invest more in defence and security to defend against Russian aggression	Support	Do Not Support	11774	33.49
European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations	Do Not Support	Support	2081	5.92
European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations	Don't Know	Support	178	0.51
European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations	Support	Do Not Support	3594	10.22
European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations	Support	Don't Know	313	0.89
European countries should invest more in trade and diplomacy with Russia to improve relations	Support	Support	4114	11.70
Neither/DK	Do Not Support	Support	994	2.83
Neither/DK	Support	Do Not Support	3668	10.43